



English Highway Podcast

Pronunciation: The long /a/ (#0259)

Practice the long /a/ vowel sound using vocabulary words in sentences.



Announcer:

You're about to listen to an audio lesson from OpenEnglish.com. Welcome. I'm Andres Moreno, your coach for this audio lesson. These lessons are designed to help you improve your listening and speaking skills by focusing on the fundamental sounds of the English language.

Today we will be practicing the long "a" vowel sound. If you can say the letter "a," then you're on your way! It's as easy as saying the letter "a."

Can you do it? Repeat after me:

"a"

Again, come on:

"a"

Good! Now stretch it out! Don't be afraid to say the vowel sound:

"aaa"

Longer, come on:

"aaa"

That's it!

So if someone asks you, "Where are you going?"
You can say, "I'm taking a plane to the United States."

So repeat after me:

"I'm taking a plane"

"to the United States"

"plane"

"States"

"take"

As you can see, there are three words that have the "a" sound, "take" "plane" and "States."

So repeat after me:

"take"

"taking"

"plane"

"States"

So let's try it all together, one more time. Repeat after me:

"I'm taking a plane to the United States."

Last time, come on. You can do it:

"I'm taking a plane to the United States."

Way to go! Let's keep practicing. Repeat after me:

"I'm late."

"late"

Stretch the "a" sound:

"late"

"I'm late."

Good. Here's another sentence. Repeat after me:

"I ate some Danish pastry."

Again:

"ate"

"Danish"

"pastry"

"pastry"

"Danish"

"ate"

Way to go! Now the whole sentence. Repeat after me:

"I ate some Danish pastry."

Good job! Now another sentence, repeat after me:

"Now, I'm late for the plane."

Just the words with the “a” sound now:

“late”

“plane”

Come on, stretch ‘em more:

“late”

“plane”

Good, now the whole sentence. Repeat after me:

“Now, I’m late for the plane.”

Great job! Let’s keep going. Repeat after me:

“The plane is going to the United States.”

Again! Come on, you can do it:

“The plane is going to the United States.”

Way to go! Here’s another phrase. Repeat after me:

“The German lady”

“lady”

“The German lady”

“who sold me the pastry”

“There’s the German lady who sold me the pastry.”

This is a long sentence, so let’s practice it once again:

“There’s the German lady who sold me the pastry.”

One last time, let’s take it slow:

“There’s the German lady who sold me the pastry.”

That was excellent. Let’s review the words we just practiced with the long “a” sound. Repeat after me:

“late”

“late”

“Danish”

“pastry”

"plane"

"States"

Now quicker:

"States"

"plane"

"pastry"

"Danish"

"late"

Great job! That was excellent. We worked on some long sentences this session. My recommendation is for you to listen to this audio lesson again and again until you feel confident with the long "a" sound because remember, practice makes perfect!

For additional practice, turn on your computer and go to OpenEnglish.com. At OpenEnglish, you'll find hundreds of interactive lessons and videos to help you perfect your English. Accelerate your English today. See you soon.

Additional practice: Long "a" vowel sound

Words:

plane

States

take

taking

late

The German lady

lady

who sold me the pastry

Danish

pastry

Sentences:

"I'm taking a plane to the United States."

"I'm late."

"The plane is going to the United States."

"There's the German lady who sold me the pastry."